

Lab 6 Participant Workbook

Build a decision-ready PowerPoint from contradictory project evidence.

OUTCOME

Produce an eight-slide steering committee deck that is traceable to evidence, preserves uncertainty and safely applies one approved parameter change.

Files you need

- Project Northstar Project Brief.docx
- Project Northstar Readiness Tracker.xlsx
- Project Northstar Meeting Notes.docx
- Change Notice CN-NS-014.pdf
- Project Northstar Corporate Template.pptx
- Project Northstar Verified Decision Brief.docx
- Source-to-Slide Verification.xlsx
- PowerPoint Copilot Prompt Card.pdf

Success criteria

- Eight slides or fewer
- Facts separated from proposals
- Unresolved evidence visible
- Sources in speaker notes
- Corporate template preserved
- Only the launch-date field changed
- Final decision remains with the Steering Committee

Exercise 1 - Define the presentation contract

Complete the fields before using Copilot.

Contract field	How to answer
Audience	
Decision required	
Maximum slides	
Authoritative source	
Must not invent	
Required tone	
Presentation duration	

Proposed slide architecture

Slide	Purpose	Approximate %
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		

Exercise 2 - Evidence and contradiction register

Use the evidence prompt, then record the most important findings in the Excel verification workbook.

Item	Value or statement	Source	Status

DO NOT RESOLVE BY PREFERENCE

When two sources conflict, identify the authority and ask for clarification. A newer approved change notice can override only the field it explicitly names.

Exercise 3 - Create the draft

- 1 Open the Northstar corporate template and save a new copy.
- 2 Open Copilot from the ribbon or lower-right Copilot button.
- 3 Select Create presentation from file.
- 4 Choose the Verified Decision Brief.
- 5 Add the presentation contract and request eight slides.
- 6 Review the outline before accepting substantial changes.
- 7 Save the result as Project_Northstar_Steering_Committee_Draft.pptx.

Optional route - PowerPoint Agent

- 1 Open Microsoft 365 Copilot.
- 2 Open Tools or Agents.
- 3 Choose PowerPoint.
- 4 Attach the Verified Decision Brief.
- 5 Enter the same presentation contract.
- 6 Open the created file in PowerPoint and continue with the audit.

Draft observations

Category	Observations
Brand/layout	
Slide structure	
Unsupported content	
Missing content	
Speaker notes	

Exercise 4 - Audit every claim

Run the audit prompt before editing. Then compare Copilot output with the source-to-slide workbook.

Slide	Claim / finding	Source support	Correction

Mandatory corrections

- Unsupported weekly delay cost removed or labelled Not confirmed
- Conditional Go labelled proposal
- 29 September tied to CN-NS-014
- Targets not presented as achieved benefits
- Missing owners remain Not confirmed

Exercise 5 - Change one parameter only

APPROVED CHANGE

Launch date: 15 September 2026 -> 29 September 2026. Nothing else changed.

Impact assessment

Location	Current date	Approved replacement	Apply?

Control questions

- Did Copilot propose unrelated wording changes?
- Did the old date remain in speaker notes?
- Did it change a forecast date accidentally?
- Did it alter scope, budget, owner or recommendation?
- Would a manual one-value edit be safer?

Exercise 6 - Improve one weak slide

Select the risk slide. Ask for three visual structures but do not allow modification until you choose.

Structure	What does it mean to you?	What does it tell you?	Why not?
Risk heat map			
Decision table			
Risk-evidence-mitigation			

Chosen structure and reason

Exercise 7 - Speaker notes and presentation controls

- 1 Open View.
- 2 Open the Notes dropdown.
- 3 Choose Generate speaker notes for current slide or all slides.
- 4 Review each note.
- 5 Keep useful notes and remove unsupported statements.
- 6 Add a [Sources] block to every slide.

Final control checklist

Checklist	Completed	Comments
All figures verified		
Facts and proposals separated		
Sources in notes		
Old date removed		
No unrelated changes		
Template preserved		
Accessibility check completed		
Decision request clear		

Reflection and debrief

- 1 What looked convincing but lacked evidence?
- 2 Which conflict did Copilot resolve too quickly?
- 3 Where was a manual edit safer than a broad Copilot instruction?
- 4 Did the visual design make any weak evidence appear stronger?
- 5 What controls would you keep for a real client presentation?

Participant conclusion